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## Subbarao Kambhampati ( సుబ్బారావు కంభంపాటి )



Professor!

[Dept. of Computer Science & Engg.](#), (Office: BY560)

[Fulton School of Engineering](#)

[Arizona State University, Tempe Arizona](#) 85287-5406

Phone: (480) 965-0113, Fax: (480) 965-2751, Email: [rao\\_who\\_lives\\_at\\_asu.edu](mailto:rao_who_lives_at_asu.edu)

(Former President, [AAAI](#); Fellow, [AAAI](#), [AAAS](#), [ACM](#))



**Research:** [Yochan](#) | [Students](#) | [Robots](#) | [Publications](#) | [Surveys](#) | [Yochan](#) | [Yochan-I3](#) | [Model-lite](#) | [Planning List](#) | [Press](#)

**Teaching:** [Student Comments](#) | [Intro to AI](#) | [Info. Integ](#) | [Grad AI](#) | [Planning](#) | [ASU101](#) | [Outreach..](#) | [YouTube Channel](#)

**Personal:** [CV](#) | [Bio](#) | [Travel](#) | [Usenet Postings](#) | [Doctors in the family](#) | [Photos](#)

**Other:** [Blog!](#) | [Bibfinder](#) | [QUIC/QPIAD](#) | [ET-I3](#) | [ICAPS Festivus](#)

**Tutorials:** [Synthesizing Explainable and Deceptive Behavior for Human-AI Interaction \(AAAI-20\)](#) | [Preferences and Partial Satisfaction in Planning \(AAAI-10\)](#) | [Information Integration \(AAAI-07\)](#) | [Planning Graph Heuristics \(IJCAI-07\)](#) | [Learning for Planning \(MLSS-06\)](#) | [Advances in Planning \(AAAI-00\)](#) | [more..](#)

[I have written several columns on the impacts of AI for The Hill](#)

[An interview with me in the series Humans of AI:Stories, Not Stats](#)

[Polanyi's Revenge and AI's New Romance with Tacit Knowledge \(CACM Viewpoint\)](#)

[Various media statements/interviews related to AI](#)

[Videos of my recent research talks..](#)

[Checkout my over-the-top opening statement at the AAAI 2020 debate on Academic AI Research in an age of Industry Labs](#)

[Talk at the 2020 Samsung AI Forum on Human-Aware AI](#)

[Polanyi vs. Planning \(Planning around AI's New Romance with Tacit Knowledge\) \(Invited talk at ICAPS 2020 DC\).](#)

[Defending Our Reality In the Era of Deep Fakes](#) **Talk at Big Data & AI Toronto**

[Synthesizing Explainable Behavior for Human-AI Collaboration](#) **AAMAS 2019 Keynote (Montreal, May 15, 2019).** (Here is a [version of the talk given at the annual meeting of](#)

[Taiwan Association of AI](#)

[Challenges of Human-Aware AI Systems](#) **AAAI Presidential Address. (New Orleans, Feb 4, 2018)**

[Distinguished lecture at Jonsson School; UT Dallas; Feb 2019\)](#)

[AI: Current and Emerging Capabilities and Research](#) **(A presentation given at National Academy of Science in March 2019)**

[Keynote Presentation on AI/ML given at FCC Forum on AI/ML](#) **(Nov 30, 2018)**

[Rise of AI: Status, Challenges, Impacts.](#) **A plenary public lecture given at TU Delft as part of ICAPS/CPAIOR 2018. (June 27, 2018)**

[Our Relationship with AI Panel at the Computer History Museum, Mountain View, CA.](#) **September 2017. (on YouTube)**

[AI & Cyber Security](#) **Presentation at National Academy of Science, August 2017.**

[Origins Great Debate on "Future of AI: Who is in Control?"](#)

[My "Last Lecture": You Can't Do That, Dave! Collateral Lessons from a Computational Quest to Design HAL](#)

[Check me out on the AI episode \(Episode 3\) of Bill Nye Saves The World on Netflix!](#)

[..yet more public talks \(with videos\)](#)

**Visitor number since yesterday.**

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Subbarao Kambhampati (Rao) was born a long long time ago in [Peddapuram](#) in Andhra Pradesh, India. After formative education at "the school next to Cinema Hall" (where he liked the teacher of the 1st grade so much that he stayed in that class for 2nd and 3rd grades too), the "School behind Anjaneyaswamy Temple" (which has since been demolished to make way for a sweet stall), Sri Veeraraju High School (S.V. Highschool), and Sri Raja Vatsavaayi Buchchi Seetayamma Jagapati Bahaddur Maharanee College (S.R.V.B.S.J.B.M.R. College, no less!), he survived JEE and did his Bachelors in Electrical Engineering (Electronics!--although he still couldn't repair the tape recorder to his father's satisfaction) at the [Indian Institute of Technology, Madras](#) (Alakananda, Jamuna & Tapati). Continuing along his degree grabbing spree, he landed a Masters and a Ph.D. degree in Computer Science from the [University of Maryland, College Park](#).

After a brief post-doctoral stint at Stanford, Rao has been having a blast crawling up the faculty hierarchy in the [Computer Science department at ASU](#) since 1991. He started as a quarter professor, became a half Professor in 1996 and a FULL (!) Professor in 2000. Continuing this geometric rise, his current goal is to become two professors very soon (he is waiting for the furlough season to pass first though, lest he be hit with two furloughs).

Rao directs the [Yochan](#) research group which is associated with the [AI Lab](#) at ASU. In the good old days, he used to be mostly interested in planning and decision-making capabilities for autonomous agents. Lately he discovered humans, and decided they are fun to keep around as AI takes over the world. Accordingly, his current research agenda revolves mainly around [human-aware AI systems](#).

He is the recipient of a 1992 [NSF Research Initiation Award](#), a 1994 [NSF young investigator](#) award, a [2001-2002 College of Engineering teaching excellence award](#), and a 2004 [IBM Faculty Award](#) and multiple [Google Research Awards](#) (2007, 2010, 2013 & 2016). In 2004, he was named a [Fellow of AAAI](#) (Association for Advancement of Artificial Intelligence). In 2011, he was selected by ASU students to give a [Last Lecture](#). In 2017, he was [elected a fellow of the American Association for the Advancement of Science \(AAAS\)](#). In 2018, he was dubbed a ["distinguished alumnus"](#) by the Computer Science Department of University of Maryland, College Park (with his own [wall plaque and all!](#)). In 2019, he was [named a fellow of the Association for the Computing Machinery \(ACM\)](#). In 2022, IIT Madras also relented and recognized him as a ["distinguished alumnus" of the Institute!](#). He is also the recipient of the 2025 AAAI/EAAI Patrick H. Winston Outstanding Educator Award.

Within his department, he has been recognized both for his teaching ([Teacher of the year](#), 2012) and research (Best Researcher, 2005, 2017). What Rao lacks in a Wikipedia page, he more than makes up with his [IMDB page](#).

He has been an invited speaker at multiple conferences starting way back with [AAAI 1996](#) and . He also gave a couple of well received tutorials on planning and databases, including one on [automated planning \(AAAI-2000\)](#), one on [information integration on the web \(AAAI-2002 and AAAI-2007\)](#), and one on [planning graph heuristics \(ICAPS 2006, IJCAI 2007\)](#).

Click [here](#) for further biographical information. [Here](#) is a detailed CV in pdf.

## Professional service:

Rao served as the president of [AAAI](#), the Association for the Advancement of Artificial Intelligence, and did his bit to [save the world from the impending Robot armageddon](#). He was also a founding board of director of [Partnership on AI](#). More recently, he is serving as the chair of [AAAS Section T \(Information, Communication and Computation\)](#).

In 2013, Rao has been elected to the [IJCAI Board of Trustees](#), and had great fun [program-chairing](#) the first-ever leap year edition of [IJCAI 2016](#) that just concluded in New York.

In the past, Rao served as the program co-chair for the 2005 National Conference on Artificial Intelligence [AAAI-05](#), which in the impartial opinion of many people such as him was the best AAAI ever (at least in 2005..). More, recently he co-chaired the 2010 [AAAI special track on AI & Web](#), and served as a [councilor for AAAI](#) for a three year term 2009-2012. He served as the conference committee chair for AAAI during 2012-2014.

Rao served as the program co-chair for [ICAPS 2013](#) and as an area chair for [IJCAI 2013](#). He will be a senior program committee member for AAAI and ICAPS in 2014. He also co-chaired the [2000 AI Planning and Scheduling \(AIPS\) Conference](#), sat on the exalted [ICAPS](#) executive committee (2002-2008).

He is on the editorial board of [ACM Transactions on Intelligent Systems and Technology](#) and [IEEE Intelligent Systems](#), and serves on the advisory board of [JAIR](#) (for which, he was an associate editor earlier). He also served on the editorial board for the [AI Magazine](#).

He had been on the program committees of most AAAs since 1992; all AIPS, (most) ECP and all ICAPS conferences, as well as a smattering of database conferences. He served on the senior program committees of AAAI 2006,2008,2011,2012 and IJCAI 2007 (area chair) and 2009.

His professional service and his late-night TV viewing intersected for once recently when he agreed to run the first-ever [Festivus](#) at an academic conference!

## Publications:

Here are [online versions of Rao's \(okay, mostly his students'\) publications](#). There is mounting evidence that at least some of these are [actually read by others](#). [One of them](#) even received a [runner-up award for 10 year influential paper](#) at ICAPS 2010. You can also find Rao's tutorials/survey talks and such [here](#)

## Talks & Tutorials:

Here are some of the recent overview talks and tutorials:

- **NEW NEW** [Wittgenstein's papers and Faraday's talks: Maxims for a Milk-fed Researcher](#) (An invited talk given at [IJCAI 2013 Doctoral Consortium](#))
- **NEW NEW** [Back to the Future of Planning](#), talk at [ACAI/ICAPS Summer School on Automated Planning and Scheduling](#)
- [Incomplete Domain Models, Uncertain Users and Open Worlds: Model-Lite Planning for Autonomy in the Presence of Humans](#), talk at ONR/IPAM Machine Reasoning workshop. Oct 2010.
- **NEW NEW** [Preferences and Partial Satisfaction in Planning](#). A tutorial delivered at AAAI 2010 (with J. Benton and Jorge Baier).
- **NEW NEW** [Incomplete domain models, uncertain users and open worlds: Foundations of Model-lite Planning](#) Seminar at CMU Robotics Institute; 4/2/2010 ([Streaming video](#)) **NEW NEW**
- [How to write a good paper](#) (An invited mentoring talk at ICAPS 2009 Doctoral consortium)
- Real World Planning: Soft Constraints & Incomplete Models (Colloquium talk given at [IHMC](#) and [WUSTL CSE](#) during Sept/Oct 2007) and [IIT Madras](#) in July 2008. Slides ([pdf](#) and [ppt](#)) and [Audio](#) ([WUSTL](#)).
- Human-Aware AI (talk given at [UW seminar on "Future of AI"](#), Nov 2007) ([ppt](#) and [audio](#))
- Do Robots need a Bill of Rights? (A [Science Cafe](#) Discussion with Attorney David Calverley at AZ Science Center, Nov 2007) ([Audio](#)).
- [Learning for Planning](#), a tutorial given at ICAPS 2007 (joint with Sungwook Yoon).
- [Information Integration on the Web \(AAAI 2007 Tutorial with Craig Knoblock\)](#)
- [Planning & Scheduling with Oversubscribed Resources, Preferences and Soft Constraints \(AAAI 2007 Tutorial, with Minh Do and Terry Zimmerman\)](#)
- [Planning Graph Based Reachability Heuristics](#) (A tutorial given at ICAPS 2006 and IJCAI 2007; Joint with Dan Bryce)
- [Learning & Planning](#). (Lectures given at Machine Learning Summer School, Canberra, Feb 2006)
- Scaleup Revolution in Automated Planning (A colloquium given at RMIT, Melbourne, Feb 2006). [Slides](#) ([audio](#)).
- [Adaptive Information Integration](#) A seminar given at USC/ISI (November, 2004)
- [1001 ways to skin a planning graph for Heuristic Fun and Profit \(ICAPS invited talk, June 2003\)](#)
- [Information Integration Tutorial \(AAAI 2002; with Craig Knoblock\)](#)
- [Integrating Planning and Scheduling: Status and Prospects. Invited talk at KBCS 2000, Bombay, India.](#)
- [Tutorial on automated planning \(AAAI-2000; IJCAI-1999\)](#)
- [Winning by being Lazy: Hierarchy, Abstraction and Least Commitment in the New-Age Planning \(Invited talk at 1998 NIPS workshop on Reinforcement Learning\)](#)
- [Refinement Planning: Status and Prospectus \(AAAI 1996 Invited Talk\)](#)

## Teaching:

Rao thinks it is way cool to get paid for filling space with the sound of his own voice. Some students seem to agree with him, going as far as to get him assorted [teaching awards](#), or aggressively stuffing ballots to get him a [Teacher of the Year](#) nod. Others are more inscrutable, trying their best to make him give [the last lecture](#). He recently became the recipient of the 2025 AAAI/EAAI Patrick H. Winston Outstanding Educator Award!

Here, at any rate, are [student comments](#) and [beauty numbers](#) from the teaching evaluations. Finally, here is an ornate statement of his [teaching philosophy](#) that Rao was asked to write for a teaching award nomination. Here is a bit of [media coverage of Rao's teaching methods](#) (and here he is trying to improve his publication count [through letters to editor](#)).

Most of his courses are available these days on his very own [Youtube Channel](#):

- [CSE591: Human-Aware AI \(Fall 2018\)](#)
  - [HON294: Invitation to AI \(Fall 2020\)](#)
  - [CSE471: Intro to AI \(Senior level\)](#)
  - [CSE571: Artificial Intelligence \(graduate level\)](#)
  - [CSE494: Information retrieval, mining and integration on the Internet. \(senior level\)](#)
  - [CSE574: Planning & Learning](#)
  - [CSE591E: Planning in Stochastic, Dynamic, Metric & Incomplete Worlds](#)
  - [ASU 101](#)
  - [Markoviana](#)
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## Current Group Members:

- **Students:**
    - [Siddhant Bhambri](#) (Spring 2021- ; Ph.D.)
    - [Karthik Valmeekam](#) (Fall 2021- ; Ph.D.)
    - [Upasana Biswas](#) (Fall 2023- ; Ph.D. )
      - Fulton Fellow
    - [Lucas Saldyt](#) (Spring 2024- ; PhD)
    - [Durgesh Kalwar](#) (Fall 2024 - ; PhD)
      - Fulton Fellow
    - [Soumya Rani Samineni](#) (Fall 2024 - ; PhD)
    - [Kaya Stechly](#) (Summer 2023- ; MS Linguistics)
    - [Atharva Gundawar](#). (Summer 2024 - ; MS Computer Science).
    - ..not to forget [Kramer, Newman and Sprinkles...](#)
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## Alumni:

- **Visiting Scholars/PostDocs:**
  - Chao Qi, Huazhong University of Science and Technology (Visiting faculty scholar; Summer 2016-Summer 2017)
  - [Yu Zhang](#) (Postdoc; Summer 2013--Summer 2015); Research Assistant Professor (Fall-- --2015-).
    - Tenure Track Faculty Member; CIDSE; ASU (Fall 2016 -- )
  - [Satya Gautam Vadlamudi](#) (Postdoc; Spring 2015--Summer 2016)



- [Hankz Hankui Zhuo \(2012-2013\) & \(Spring-Fall 2015\) \(Faculty member; Sun Yat-sen University\)](#)
- [Sungwook Yoon \(2006-2008\); was an Assistant Research Professor at ASU. Currently a Research Scientist at \(Xerox\) PARC, Palo Alto..](#)

## • Ph.D.:

31. [Dr! Lin Guan](#) (Fall 2019-Fall 2024; Ph.D.)
  - Ph.C. (Candidacy). [March 25, 2024]
  - Ph.D. (Defense). [Oct 21, 2024] ([Defense Video](#))
  - First Employment: Research Scientist with Meta GenAI
30. [Dr!Mudit Verma](#) (Fall 2019-Summer 2024 ; Ph.D.) (Defended [Aug 20, 2024])
  - Ph.C. (Candidacy). [May 15, 2024]
  - Ph.D. (Defense). [Aug 20, 2024] ([Defense Video](#))
  - First Employment: Research Scientist with Google DeepMind.
29. [Dr!Utkarsh Soni](#) (Spring 2019-Spring 2024 ; Ph.D.) (Defended [Apr 12, 2024])
  - [Defense Video](#)
  - [Ph.C. \(Candidacy\) \[Oct 18, 2023\] Proposal Video](#)
  - First employment: Data Scientist at ManuLife.
28. [Dr! Zahra Zahedi](#) (Fall 2018-2023 ; Ph.D.) [Defended [Nov 2, 2023]]
  -  Dean's Dissertation Award for 2024.
  -  HRI Pioneer Recognition. 2024.
  - [Defense Video](#)
  - Ph.C. (Candidacy) [Aug 14, 2023] [Proposal Video](#)
  - First Employment: Scientist, Honda Research.
27. [Dr! Alberto Olmo](#) (Fall 2018-Fall 2022 ; Ph.D., Defended [Nov 2, 2022])
  - [Defense Video](#)
  - Ph.C. (Candidacy) [Apr 15, 2022]
  - First employment: MLOPS Engineer @ Vianai Systems.
26. [Dr! Sriram Gopalakrishnan](#) (Fall 2017-Fall 2022) Ph.D. Defended [Oct 28, 2022].
  - [Defense Video](#)
  - First Employment: AI Research Scientist, JP Morgan AI Research.
25. [Dr! Sachin Grover](#) (Fall 2016--Summer 2022) Ph.D. Defended [Jul 18, 2022]
  - Ph.C. (Candidacy) [Oct 15, 2021]
  - First employment: Research Scientist, (Xerox) PARC --> SRI
24. [Dr! Sarath Sreedharan](#) (Fall 2016--Summer -- --2022)(Ph.D.) Defended [Jun 28, 2022]. [Thesis](#); [Defense Video](#)
  -  ICAPS Distinguished Dissertation Award (Runner-up). 2023.
  -  Dean's Dissertation Award for 2022 [Nov, 2022]
  - Ph.C. (Candidacy) [Jul 23, 2021]. Proposal [Video](#)
  -  [AAAI-20 Outstanding Prpgram Committee Member award \(one of 12 recognized\).](#)
  -  Recipient of the 2017 CSE Outstanding Masters Student award.
  - First employment: Assistant Professor, Colorado State University
23. [Dr! Yantian Zha](#) (Fall 2015-17:MS; Fall 2017: Ph.D.) (Defended [Jun 7, 2022])
  - Ph.C. (Candidacy) [Oct 18, 2021].
  - Defense [Jun 7, 2022]. [Thesis Defense presentation](#)
  - First employment: Postdoctoral Fellow at Marlyland Robotics, UMD.
22. [Dr! Anagha Kulkarni](#) (Fall 2015 - Spring 2021) (Ph.D.) (Proposal on [May 1, 2020])(Defense on [Mar 3, 2021])
  - Defense presentation [Video](#) [Mar 3, 2021]
  - Proposal Presentation [Video](#) [May 1, 2020]
  -  ICAPS Distinguished Dissertation Award (Runner-up). 2022.
  - First Employment: AI Research Scientist at Invitae.

21. [Dr! Sailik Sengupta](#) (Fall 2015-Fall 2020)(Ph.D.)(Proposal on [Apr 28, 2020])(Defense on [Sep 21, 2020])[Defense Video](#) ([Celebration Pics](#)) ([Dissertation](#))
  - [Proposal Presentation video](#) ([Apr 29, 2020])
  -  [IBM Ph.D. Fellowship](#) (2018-20)
  - First Employment: Research Scientist at Amazon AI
20. [Dr! Lydia Manikonda](#)(Fall 2013-Summer 2019; Defended [May 20, 2019]) (Ph.D) [Defense Video \(+ slides\)](#) ([Dissertation](#))
  - First Employment: Faculty member at RPI
19. [Dr! Tathagata Chakraborty](#)(Fall 2013-Fall 2018; Defended [Nov 5, 2018]). [Defense Video \( Post-defense Celebration Photos\)](#) (Ph.D) ([Dissertation](#))
  - First Employment: IBM Research AI
  -  [Named to IEEE AI 10 To Watch, 2020](#)
  -  [ICAPS Distinguished Dissertation Award \(Runner-up\)](#). 2019.
  -  ASU CIDSE Outstanding Ph.D. Student. 2019.
  -  IBM Ph.D. Fellowship (2016-17) ([A news story](#))
  -  [IBM Ph.D. Fellowship](#) (2017-18)
18. [Dr! Yuheng Hu](#)(Spring 2010-) (Ph.D) NEW NEW Defended: [Nov 14, 2014] ([Video of the defense](#)) ([Slides\(pptx\)](#))([Dissertation](#)) ; Ph.D. Candidacy: [December 12, 2013] ( [video](#) and [slides](#) from the proposal defense; (Ph.D)
  - Faculty member, Dept of Information and Decision Sciences, University of Illinois, Chicago.
  - [Best Paper Honorable Mention, CHI 2013](#)
17. [Dr! Kartik Talamadupula](#)(Spring 2007-) (Bachelors; Dec 2007)(M.S.-> Ph.D.(Fall 2008- ) NEW NEW NEW Defended [Nov 6, 2014]. ([Video of the defense](#)) (Ph.D. Candidacy: [Nov 18, 2013]. Proposal presentation: ( [video](#))[slides \(pptx\)](#) [slides \(pdf\)](#) [Dissertation](#).
  - First Employment: IBM Watson Labs (Research Staff Member)
  -  [CSE Distinguished Senior award, 2008](#).
  -  [CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Student \(honorable mention\), 2008](#) ( [local press](#)) 2
  - Recipient of [FURI](#) and CS UG Research grants)
  - Science Foundation of Arizona (SFAZ) Fellow (2008).
16. [Dr! Sushovan De](#)(Spring 2009-Spring 2014) NEW NEW Defended [May 20, 2014] ([Dissertation](#)) Ph.D. Candidacy: [July 12, 2013] ( [video excerpt](#) from the proposal defense) (Ph.D)
  - First Employment: Google
15. [Dr! Tuan Anh Nguyen](#)(Fall 2007-Spring 2014) (Ph.D) NEW Defended [May 5, 2014] (Video of the defense: [Part 1 \(1h 3min\)](#) [Part 2 \(5 min\)](#)) [slides \(pptx\)](#) [slides \(pdf\)](#) [Dissertation](#). NEW Ph.D. Candidacy: [Jul 18, 2012]. ([Proposal presentation video](#))
  - First Employment: Mathworks
  - [Science Foundation of Arizona \(SFAZ\) Fellow \(2007\)](#)
14. [Dr! William Cushing](#) (Spring 2004-Fall 2012) M.S. -> Ph.D. NEW NEW Ph.D. Candidacy: [Dec 2, 2011]. Defended: [Nov 16, 2012] ( [Presentation Slides](#); Video of the defense: [Part 1](#) and [Part 2](#); [the dissertation](#)) ([Defense Photos](#))
  - First Employment: Post-doc at Berkeley (with Stuart Russell)
  - Fulton Fellow for 2006-07
  - University Graduate Scholar 2006-07
13. [Dr! J. Benton](#) (Spring 2004-) (Defended M.S. thesis [Jul 19, 2005]). Ph.D. ( NEW NEW Defended successfully [Jul 18, 2012]) ([Photos](#)) ([Defense video](#)) , [presentation slides](#) and [the dissertation](#).
  - Currently, Senior Research Scientist, NASA AMES.
  - Candidacy: 4/22/2011 (Presentation [video](#) and [audio](#))
  -  J. and his planner won a swanky cup and a certificate for [distinguished performance](#) at the [2006 Intl. Planning Competition](#).
  - ARCS fellow for 2009.
12. [Dr! Raju Balakrishnan](#)(Spring 2007-) Ph.D. ( NEW NEW Successfully defended [Jul 19, 2012]) ([Photos](#)) (Defense Video [Part 1](#) and [Part 2](#)); [the presentation slides](#) and [the dissertation](#).

- First Employment: Groupon
  - Candidacy: 2/22/2011 (Presentation [video](#) and [audio](#))
  -  [Recipient of Yahoo! Key Scientific Challenges Program Award \(2009-10\).](#)
  -  [Recipient of WWW 2010 Best Poster Award.](#)
11. [Dr! Menkes van den Briel \(Spring 2003-\) Ph.D. \(Ph.C. since \[Dec 15, 2005\]\) Defended Successfully \[Jul 31, 2008\] \(Thesis slides. audio\) \(Pictures\)](#) (First employment: Reseach faculty at Leeds School of Business, U. Colorado; Currently at NICTA Canberra)
    -  Recipient of an [honorable mention](#) for the 2009 ICAPS Best Dissertation Award.
    - Menkes was in the news a lot once for his earlier work on effective strategies for airplane boarding. (He was even on [Wall Street Journal front page](#) recently; and also on [Wired](#);-)
  10. [Dr. Dan Bryce \(Summer 2002-\) Ph.D. \(Ph.C. since \[Nov 18, 2005\]\)\(Defended \[Apr 20, 2007\]!\). \(Thesis Slides. Audio \) \(Pictures\)](#) (Currently on the faculty at [Utah State University](#))
    -   Recipient of the 2009 ICAPS Best Dissertation [Award](#) (Here is the [talk video](#)) (Some [press at USU](#))
    - ARCS fellow for 2005 and 2006.
    - Recipient of Deans scholarship for 2006.
    - Recipient of Dissertation scholarship for 2007.
    - CS dept nominee for the College outstanding graduate student award, 2007.
  9. [Dr. Ullas Nambiar](#)(Spring 2000-; Ph.D. Candidacy May 2004) Defended [Aug 15, 2005]! ( [Thesis](#), [Pictures](#)). (Currently, [Senior Vice President for AI and Product Management at Accenture](#) (Previously, IBM IRL, Zensar etc.)
  8. [Dr. Romeo Sanchez Nigenda\(Fall 1999-Summer 2005; MCS & PhD\). Defended successfully \[Jul 18, 2005\] \(pics\), \(Thesis\)](#) Ph.D. (Currently on the faculty at [UANL](#)) (Was a Computer Scientist at USC Information Sciences Institute).
  7. [Dr. Binh Minh Do](#) (Spring 99-Fall 2004), Ph.D. (Defended Aug 6, 2004. [Thesis](#), [Pictures!](#)). (First Employment: [PARC](#)). Currently Senior Research Scientist at NASA AMES P&S group.
    -  Recipient of the 2005 Dept of CSE Best PhD Award.
    - ASU Nominee for ACM Distinguished Dissertation Award.
    -   [ICAPS 2010 Influential Paper Award \(Honorable mention\)](#)
  6. [Dr. Zaiqing Nie \(Fall 99-Spring 2004\) Ph.D. \(Defended Mar 12, 2004! Thesis\).](#) (Currently [Named Professor at Tsinghua University](#)) (Previously at MSR Asia and Alibaba AI)
  5. [Dr. Terry Zimmerman Ph.D. \(Defended Oct 24, 2003! See Thesis and pics\).](#) (First Employment: [Project Scientist, Robotics Institute, CMU](#))
  4. [Dr. Xiaomin Li \(Ph.D. 2001\). \(Currently at Oracle\)](#)
  3. [Dr. Biplav Srivastava \(M.S. 96; Ph.D. 2000 Thesis\).\(Defense pictures from 1/28/2000\)](#) (Currently: [Faculty member at Univ of South Carolina](#) (Previously at IBM IRL and IBM Research)
  2. [Dr. Amol Dattatreya Mali \(Summer 96-Spring 99\).\(Associate Professor; University of Wisconsin, Milwaukee.\)](#)
  1. [Dr. Laurie Ihrig \(Ph.D. 96\) \(with Boeing\)](#)

## • Masters:

35. [Karthik Valmeekam](#) (Fall 2019 - Spring 2021; MS) (Defended M.S. Thesis [Apr 14, 2021])
34. [Niharika Jain](#) (Spring 2018-Spring 2020; FURI; 4+1)(Defended M.S. Thesis [Apr 29, 2020]) ([Thesis](#))([Slides](#)) ([Defense Video](#)) (Off to LinkedIn)
  -  Outstanding M.S. Student, Computer Science (Spring 2021)
  -  Outstanding Undergraduate, Computer Science (Spring 2019)
33. [Aditya Prasad Mishra](#) (Spring 2018-Spring 2019; M.S.) **NEW** Defended: [Apr 12, 2019]
32. [Sarath Sreedharan](#) (Fall 2014-Summer 2016)(M.S.) Defended: [Jun 30, 2016] ([Thesis](#)) ([Presentation Slides](#)) ([Video of the Defense](#))
  -  Recipient of the 2017 CSE Outstanding Masters Student award.



31. [Vignesh Narayanan](#) (Spring 2014-)(M.S.) Defended: [Nov 10, 2015] ([Thesis](#)) ([Presentation Slides](#)) ([Video of the Defense](#))
30. [Anirudh Acharya](#) (Spring 2014-)(M.S.) Successfully defended [Jul 20, 2015]) (off to Yahoo!)
29. [Tejas Mallapura Umamaheshwar](#) (Fall 2014-Summer 2015)(M.S.) Successfully defended [Jun 16, 2015]) (off to Mathworks)
28. Mi Jun (Spring 2013--2015)(M.S.; RIP; passed away April 2015 ([InMemorium](#))
27. [Manikandan Vijayakumar](#) (Fall 2013-Summer 2014). (M.S.) Successfully defended [Jul 7, 2014]. ([Thesis](#)) ([Presentation Slides](#)) (Off to American Express)
26. [Preeth Inder Singh](#) (Summer 2012--)(MS) (defended [Sep 16, 2013]). ( [Thesis](#), [Slides](#) and [Presentation video](#)) (Off to Bloomberg LP R&D)
25. [Srijith Ravikumar](#) (Fall 2011--Spring 2013)(MS) (defended [Apr 18, 2013]). ( [Thesis](#), [Slides](#) and [Presentation video](#)) (Off to Amazon)
24. [Manishkumar Jha](#)(Summer 2010-Summer 2011) (M.S.) (defended [Aug 26, 2011]) ( [Thesis](#), [Slides](#) and [Presentation video](#)) (Off to Amazon)
  -  Recipient of the 2012 Dept of CSE/SCI Outstanding Masters Student award.
23. [Rohit Raghunathan](#)(Summer 2010-Summer 2011) (M.S.)(defended [Aug 19, 2011]) ([Thesis](#), [Slides](#) and [Presentation video](#)) (Off to Amazon)
22. [Christopher White](#)(Fall 2010-Summer 2011 ) (Integrated M.S.) defended [Jul 6, 2011] (Currently at Lockheed Martin)
21. [Sanil Salvi](#)(Spring 2009-Fall 2010) (MCS)
20. [Nan Li](#) (Primary advisor: Pat Langley) (2009)(MCS)
19. [Ravi Gummadi](#) (co-advised with Pat Langley) (Fall 2007-09) (M.S.) defended [Aug 25, 2009] ( [Thesis](#), [slides](#), [audio](#))) (Currently at Facebook)
18. [Anupam Khulbe](#) (co-advised with Pat Langley)(Fal 2007-09) (M.S.) Defended [Aug 25, 2009] ( [Thesis](#) and [slides](#), [audio](#)))(Currently at Amazon)
17. [Garrett Wolf](#) (Spring 2006-Fall 2008) M.S.->Ph.D.->MCS
  -  Recipient of the 2009 Dept of CSE/SCI Outstanding Masters Student award.
  - Fulton Fellow for 2007-08
16. [Aravind Krishna Kalavagattu](#)(Fall 2006-) M.S. Defended M.S. Thesis on [Jul 30, 2008]. ([Thesis](#), [slides](#), [audio](#))) Off to Yahoo!
15. [Bhaumik Chokshi](#) (Fall 2005-Sep 2007) M.S. Defended M.S. Thesis ( [Thesis](#), [slides](#), [audio](#))) on [Sep 11, 2007]). Off to Microsoft Adwords.
14. [Hemal Khatri](#) (Spring 2005-Summer 2006) (Defended M.S. thesis ([Thesis](#), [slides](#), [audio](#))) on [Jul 7, 2006]). Off to [MSN Search](#).
  -  Recipient of the 2007 Dept of CSE/SCI Outstanding MS Student award. ([Pictures](#)).
13. [Jianchun Fan](#) (Fall 2003-) [Ph.D.->M.S.](#) (Defended M.S. thesis ( [Thesis](#), [slides](#) , [audio](#))) on [Apr 13, 2006]). Off to [Amazon](#)
12. [Thomas Hernandez](#) (Spring 2003-Fall 2004)M.S. (Defended [Oct 21, 2004]!) Over at [Amazon](#) ([Thesis](#))
  -  Recipient of the 2005 Dept of CSE Outstanding MS Student award.
11. [Sreelakshmi Vaddi](#) MCS 2003.
10. [Xuan Long Nguyen](#) (M.S. 2001 Thesis). ([Faculty member in U. Michigan Statistics](#))
9. [Senthil Gnanaprakasam](#) (M.S. 2001 )(Intel) ([Thesis](#))
8. [Eric Lambrecht](#) (Summer 96-Summer 98). M.S. Thesis (Founded several internet companies)
7. [Yong Qu](#) (M.S. 95; a run-of-the-mill millionaire at Microsoft)
6. [Eric Cohen](#) (M.C.S. 93; with American Express or in Brazil)
5. [Dennis Chen](#) (M.C.S. 93)
4. [Jeng-chin Chen](#) (M.C.S. 92)
3. [Suresh Kumar Batchu](#) (M.C.S. 95, Sun Microsystems->Google)
2. [Gopi Kumar Bulusu](#) (M.C.S. 93; Head Honcho at Sankhya Systems, India)
1. [Suresh Katukam](#) (M.S. 1995 Thesis; with CISCO)

• **Undergraduate Research Students:**

- Denis Liu (Spring 2021--Spring 2024; FURI, UG research).
- Aditya Deotale (Spring 2017-Spring 2018; FURI).
  -  Top Poster Prize; FURI Symposium; Spring 2018. award.
- Daniel D'Souza (Spring 2015-)(URAP,FURI). Honors thesis, Spring 2017.
- Gabriel Saba (Spring 2016-) Honors thesis, Spring 2017.
- Cameron Dudley (Spring 2016-)
- Jake Merdich (Summer 2015; URAP)
- Nathaniel Mendoza (Summer 2014-Spring 2015)(URAP; FURI)
- Sumbhav Sethia (Summer 2013-Fall 2014)(URAP; FURI)
- Wyatt Tyree (Summer 2014-Fall 2014)(URAP)
- Paul Reesman (Summer 2013)(URAP)
- Matthew Mellott (Fall 2012--Spring 2013)(NSF REU, FURI Scholar)
- Nicole Ang (Fall 2012)(NSF REU)
- James Fiacco (Fall 2011) (FURI Scholar)
- [Alex Wallace](#)(Summer 2009-Spring 2010) (B.S. honors thesis. [Thesis](#)) (Currently at U. Arizona Med school)
- [Chris White](#)(Fall 2009-Spring 2010) (B.S. honors thesis)(Continued for Integrated M.S.)
- Alan Hogan (Spring 2008) (Undergraduate FURI Scholar)
- [Kartik Talamadupula](#)(Spring 2007-) (Bachelors; Dec 2007)(Continued for PhD)
  - [CSE Distinguished Senior award, 2008.](#)
  - [CRA Outstanding Undergraduate Student \(honorable mention\), 2008](#) ( [local press](#))
  - Receptient of [FURI](#) and CS UG Research grants)
  - Science Foundation of Arizona (SFAZ) Fellow (2008).
- [Wes Dyer](#) (Spring 2004-) Undergraduate (honors thesis) ([Thesis](#)) (Currently at Microsoft).

## • High School Interns:

- Thomas Liu, McClintock High School. Summer 2011.
  - Work on SAT phase transitions lead to [Siemens Semifinalist](#) recognition

## • Visitors etc.:

- [Anil Murthy](#) (Summer 2023-; Ph.D ) (Transferred)
- [Matthew Marquez](#) (Fall 2022-Fall 2023 ; Ph.D.) (Left program)
  - Dean's Fellow
- [Daman Arora](#) (Spring 2023-Summer 2023. Remote visitor; IIT Delhi)
- Andrew Dudley (Fall 2017-Spring 2018)
- Elan Markov (Fall 2016-Spring 2017)
- [Vamsi Meduri](#)(Spring 2015-Fall 2015) (Ph.D) (Shifted research groups)
- Vivek Dondeti, Fall 2015
- Taeyeong Choi, Fall 2015
- Divya Mokkaapati, Spring 2015
- Chao Zhou Ph.D. Student from Huazhong University of Science and Technology, China. (2012-1013).
- Jing (Mavis) Shan, Ph.D. Student from Northeastern University, China. (2012-2013)
- [Bram Ridder](#) ([Visitor from U. Strathclyde Planning Group; Fall 2010](#)).
- [T.K. Satish Kumar](#) (Visitor from Stanford KSL during Summer 2002)
- [Romain Trinquart](#) (Visitor from LAAS, France during Fall 2001)
- [Jillian Nottingham](#) (Fall 98-Fall 99), ([Non-degree](#)).
- [David Copeland](#) ([Non-degree](#)).
- [Yannick Meiller](#) ([Non-degree; doing Ph.D. in Toulouse, France](#)).
- [Bilal Muzaffar](#) (Summer 95-Spring 96).
- [Xiuping Yang](#) (Fall 95-Summer 96) ([SAP](#)).

## Doctors in the Family:

- [A doctor with a similar background ;-\)](#)
  - [My sister, a pediatrician, who is the only real doctor in the extended family](#)
  - [My brother, an economist, who does \*real\* planning](#)
  - [My sister-in-law a mathematical economist](#)
  - [My sister-in-law, an engineer at Ford](#)
  - [My brother-in-law, a mechanical engineering professor](#)
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